Charles E. Ross

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior software developer and solutions architect with more than 30 years of experience delivering custom CRM, workflow automation, and line-of-business applications across a wide range of industries and platforms. Recent work includes AI-assisted delivery of a full-stack ranch operations platform and a mortgage brokerage CRM, plus multi-year architecture ownership on a Salesforce platform that replaced a failing legacy system for a company of several hundred users. Builds software that improves access to accurate data, shifts repetitive work into automation, and owns architecture, implementation, DevOps, and client-facing technical communication end-to-end. Known for ramping quickly on unfamiliar technologies when project needs demand it and turning that ramp-up into production delivery.

CORE SKILLS

- AI-assisted development: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Replit Agent
- CRM and business systems: custom CRM, workflow automation, Salesforce Lightning Platform, FileMaker, OutSystems
- Application development: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Flask, PHP, HTML, CSS, Lightning Web Components, Apex/Java
- Statistical modeling: regression and trend fitting with pandas and NumPy in production to predict future prices for a multi-location wireless retailer (2019); statistical analysis of survey results for a separate client
- Data and integration: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SOQL, JSON, XML, XSLT, REST API integrations
- Platforms and delivery: web, macOS, Windows, iOS, FileMaker Server, Salesforce orgs, cloud environments
- Engineering practice: software design patterns, pull request code review, Git version control, multi-file refactoring, automated testing behind CI
- Additional background: AppleScript, Cocoa, Objective-C++, Xojo, UI/UX design

EXPERIENCE

Principal Developer & Consultant, Chivalry Software | 2004–Present

- Operated Chivalry Software as a boutique consultancy, serving as principal developer and technical director on multi-year client engagements, with the scope, responsibility, and delivery accountability of a senior individual contributor or technical lead at a product company.
- Delivered custom CRM, operations, and workflow applications that improved access to accurate data and shifted repetitive work into automation for clients across mortgage brokerage, legal, publishing, education, retail, entertainment, and manufacturing.
- Most recently sole developer on a full-stack ranch operations platform, owning the data model, REST API, React front end, CI pipeline, and production deployment; before that, lead developer and application architect on a mortgage brokerage CRM delivered with AI-assisted development.
- Built and shipped business systems across React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Salesforce Lightning Platform, OutSystems, FileMaker, Flask, and CakePHP, choosing the right stack for each client's workflow and delivery constraints.
- Learned PHP over a weekend to deliver a client web project on schedule, and reached productive delivery on OutSystems within a week of first exposure.
- Led a team of eight developers as primary technical decision-maker on a multi-year Salesforce platform engagement, owning architecture, DevOps, and implementation across six functional areas.
- Mentored junior developers across Salesforce, FileMaker, and web projects, and served as approving reviewer on their pull requests.

- Conducted GitHub pull request code reviews for both junior developers and peers over six-plus years, across Salesforce (Apex, LWC), React, TypeScript, and Node.js, evaluating correctness, code quality, and design consistency.
- Delivered over a dozen distinct internal tools and owned platform selection, systems design, and deployment across cloud environments, Salesforce orgs, and FileMaker Server, including a gamified training app that let salespeople confirm their training level while competing for points, and an iPad personality-assessment app used in sales-role candidate evaluation.

Selected Projects

- **Ranch Operations Platform** (2026): Sole developer on a full-stack operations platform for a working cattle ranch, covering livestock records, infrastructure, inventory, purchasing, and recurring task scheduling. Delivered 31 REST API modules and 56 data models in roughly nine weeks, with 233 automated test files behind a CI gate that fails below 100% coverage on both backend and frontend. Provisioned and operated the production environment as well: server setup, TLS, a separate staging deployment, and nightly off-site backups with a rehearsed restore drill. Stack: Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Celery, Redis, PostgreSQL, Docker; React, TypeScript, Vite. Every line of code was written by coding agents (Claude Code and Codex) and reviewed before merge.
- **Mortgage Brokerage CRM** (2025–2026): Lead developer and application architect on a full-stack custom CRM built from scratch for a live mortgage brokerage. Delivered pipeline, document, communication, and reporting workflows that streamlined day-to-day loan operations. Stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Drizzle ORM; AI-assisted development with Claude Code and Replit Agent.
- **Business Operations Platform** (2021–present): Lead developer and architect on the migration of a 200-plus-user company off a decades-old, unmaintainable FileMaker system onto Salesforce. Millions of records moved, then expanded across six functional areas: HR, recruiting, project tracking, surveys, support ticketing, and field incident reporting. Led a team of eight developers through the first two years. The platform carried the client's growth as headcount rose by roughly half. Owned architecture, DevOps, data model, and client communication throughout.
- **Salesforce Permission Assistant** (2023–2024): Senior contributor on an AppExchange utility that simplified management of complex Salesforce permission sets for enterprise-scale orgs.
- **lwc-popover-window** (2023–2024, open source): Authored a reusable Lightning Web Component enabling popover windows in Salesforce Lightning Experience. Published as open source and documented in a technical article.

Writer / Editor, Various Publications | 2000–Present

- Write and edit technical content focused on FileMaker, Salesforce, AppleScript, and software development.
- Served as technical editor for Xcode 5: Start to Finish and Xcode 6: Start to Finish, and as technical editor and contributing author (two chapters) for The Book of FileMaker.
- Published tutorials, reviews, and technical articles for Macworld Magazine, ISO FileMaker Magazine, and About This Particular Macintosh.

Manager of Software Development, Bert Howe and Associates | 2007–2008

- Developed in-house applications supporting litigation workflow and operations.
- Maintained and extended existing systems while advising on technical direction for litigation operations.

Manager of Information Systems, JobElephant.com | 2006–2007

- Built and maintained internal business operations software and vendor data exchanges.
- Administered internal macOS-based infrastructure and delivered employee support and training for day-to-day operations.

Earlier Experience

- Developer, Productive Computing | 2003–2004
- Senior Developer, Metro Technologies | 2000–2003
- Manager of Information Systems / Database Analyst, Direct Partners | 1996–1999
- Manager of Information Technologies, Grey Advertising | 1993–1996

OPEN SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Created lwc-popover-window, structured-flask, alexandria, and filemaker.vim.
- Maintained or contributed to Vim, Flask, Werkzeug, Flask-Bcrypt, Flask-Dotenv, SimpleImage, UltiSnips, and FMEasyAudit.
- Mentor on Python and JavaScript tracks at Exercism.
- Top 10% Stack Overflow user and longtime moderator on FMForums.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- University of California, Los Angeles | Bachelor of Science in Mathematics with a Specialization in Computing
- Certified FileMaker Developer
- Salesforce Superbadges: Apex Specialist (Apex/Java), Lightning Experience Specialist, Security Specialist, App Customization Specialist
- Additional training: Python, JavaScript, Responsive Web Design, Bash shell scripting, Docker and Kubernetes